

Modular Open Source Identity Platform (MOSIP): A Home-Grown Digital System for the World

The Modular Open Source Identity Platform (MOSIP), developed at IIIT-B, open sources the complete identity system, so that different countries can build their own solutions to meet specific requirements.

A few years ago, officials from many countries in the world made requests to developers of the Aadhaar project to replicate a similar system in their countries. But since Aadhaar is a proprietary system, it was very difficult to implement it in different countries that had their own set of laws with respect to data protection and privacy. Therefore, the government of India had to refuse such requests. The Aadhaar system was designed specifically for India and was not plug-and-play.

So, at IIIT-Bangalore, we started a project to put the complete identity system in open source. We wanted to provide a platform, not a solution, as the latter will differ for different countries. Solutions have to comply with the laws of that particular country. For example, countries like the Philippines, Morocco, Argentina and Mexico have to adhere to their own identity act. On the platform that we have created, called MOSIP or Modular Open Source Identity Platform, countries can build their solutions to meet specific requirements.

Since we have used the ten principles of digital identity at IIIT-B, security and privacy are built-in by design and are not an afterthought. For example, if a country is adhering to the GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), then it can make its solution GDPR-compliant using MOSIP.

MOSIP is modular. For example, if a country doesn't need a biometric based identity system, then it can do so since it can assemble its own system. And if someone else doesn't want a print based ID like our Aadhaar

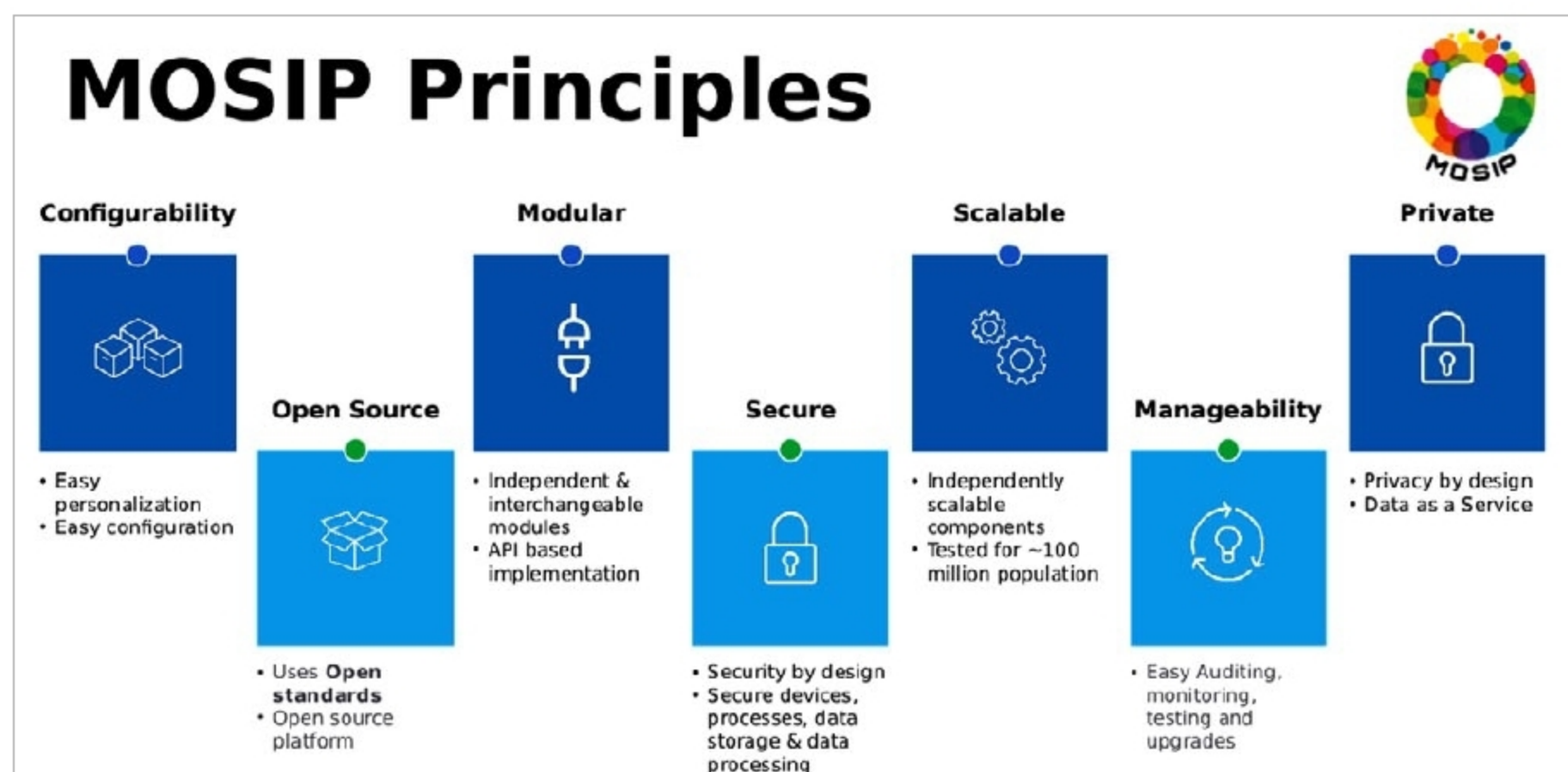


Figure 1: MOSIP principles

